

NIAA Indigenous Advancement Strategy - Remote Communities Infrastructure Fund

1. Program Overview

- **Funding Agency:** National Indigenous Australians Agency (NIAA)
 - **Program Name:** Indigenous Advancement Strategy (IAS) - Remote Communities Infrastructure Fund (RCIF)
 - **Goal:** To fund capital works and infrastructure projects that improve health, safety, and economic outcomes for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people in remote communities (MMM 6-7).
 - **Funding Value:** Grants between \$100,000 and \$2,000,000 are available.
 - **Co-Funding:** While co-funding is not mandatory, applications demonstrating co-contributions or partnerships will be prioritised.
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2. Eligibility Criteria

- **Eligible Applicants:** Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Community Controlled Organisations (ACCHOs/ACCOs), local government councils in remote areas, or registered non-profit organisations representing remote Indigenous communities.
 - **Eligible Activities:**
 - Construction or upgrade of community buildings (e.g. clinics, community centres, youth hubs).
 - Construction or refurbishment of remote key worker housing to attract medical/educational staff.
 - Minor municipal infrastructure directly benefiting community health (e.g., water filtration, local access roads, public solar lighting).
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3. Application Questions & Required Responses

Applicants must address the following criteria in their written submission:

Criterion 1: Community Need & Project Alignment (Weight: 40%)

- *Prompt:* Describe the specific infrastructure gap in your community. How will the proposed project address this need, and how does it align with the NIAA IAS objectives of promoting community safety, wellbeing, and economic self-determination?
- *Key Information Required:* Evidence of community consultation, statistical need (e.g., healthcare access barriers, overcrowding), and project scope.

Criterion 2: Organizational Capability & Delivery Plan (Weight: 30%)

- *Prompt:* Detail your organisation's track record in delivering capital works or managing remote infrastructure. Provide a project timeline, key milestone plan, and risk management strategy for remote shipping and local procurement challenges.
- *Key Information Required:* Profiles of project managers, remote delivery experience, risk register (weather, logistics, labor).

Criterion 3: Indigenous Employment & Procurement (Weight: 30%)

- *Prompt:* Explain how this project will support local First Nations employment and procurement during construction and ongoing operation. What targets have you set for local Indigenous subcontractors and training apprenticeships?
- *Key Information Required:* Projected First Nations employment hours, engagement of Supply Nation certified businesses.